SERENE

AESTHETICS, WELLNESS AND IV INFUSION CENTER

FREE GUIDE

# Lose Fat, Keep Muscle: Your Guide to Medical Weight Loss

*How physician-supervised weight loss works, why muscle matters, and how to track real progress with a free InBody scan*

SERENE MED SPA · PHYSICIAN-LED

Hudson, Ohio · Barboursville, West Virginia

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Educational guide · not medical advice


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Weight-loss medications have changed the conversation about weight. Many people now ask a simple question: is medical weight loss right for me? This guide helps you answer it with clear, practical facts.

There is one idea we want you to keep in mind as you read. The goal is not only a smaller number on the scale. The goal is to lose fat while protecting the muscle that keeps you strong, steady and active.

Inside, you'll learn how a physician-supervised program works, what the medications do (and don't do), how protein and strength training protect muscle, and how a free InBody body-composition scan can show what the bathroom scale can't. You'll also find real costs at Serene, a checklist for your first visit, and honest answers about what happens if you stop.

This guide is for education only. It is not medical advice. Results vary from person to person, and every plan starts with a conversation with a licensed clinician.

### About Serene Med Spa

Serene is a physician-led med spa with offices in Hudson, Ohio and Barboursville, West Virginia, led by Robin Arora, MD and Shweta Arora, MD. We plan every treatment around your goals and health history, and we'll tell you plainly what a treatment can and can't do.

PART 01

# What physician-supervised weight loss actually means

Medical weight loss is a plan built and monitored by a licensed physician. It treats weight as a health issue, not a willpower problem. The plan may include a prescription medication, but medication is only one part.

At Serene, our physician-led team starts with your history, your current medicines, your goals and any lab work you have. From there, we decide together whether medication makes sense, which category fits, and how to start safely. Follow-up visits let us adjust your dose, manage side effects and keep an eye on your progress.

National guidelines say prescription weight-loss medicine may be an option for adults with a body mass index (BMI) of 30 or higher, or 27 or higher with a weight-related health problem such as high blood pressure or type 2 diabetes. Meeting those numbers doesn't mean medicine is automatically right for you. That decision belongs to you and your clinician.

- A full medical review before any prescription
- A start-low, go-slow dosing plan
- Regular check-ins to adjust the plan and handle side effects
- Coaching on protein, strength training and daily habits
- Body-composition tracking so you can see fat loss versus muscle loss

PART 02

# How GLP-1 medications work

GLP-1 medications copy the action of a natural gut hormone called GLP-1. Some newer medications act on two gut hormones at once. In plain terms, they help you feel full sooner, stay full longer and think about food less. Most are taken as a once-weekly shot.

These medications are FDA-approved for chronic weight management in adults who meet certain criteria. They are meant to be used alongside changes to eating and activity. They are not a shortcut around those habits; they make the habits easier to stick with.

Doses start low and increase slowly over several weeks. This step-by-step approach gives your body time to adjust and helps limit stomach side effects. Your clinician will tell you when and how to move up, and when to hold steady.

Not everyone responds the same way. Federal health guidance notes that if a person hasn't lost at least 5% of their starting weight after about 12 weeks on a full dose, their clinician may recommend a different plan.

**Who should not take these medications**

GLP-1 medications are not used during pregnancy, when planning a pregnancy, or while breastfeeding. They are also not used in people with a personal or family history of medullary thyroid cancer or a condition called MEN 2. Tell your clinician about every medicine you take and your full health history.

PART 03

## Why muscle loss matters

When you lose weight, you don't lose only fat. You also lose some lean mass, which includes muscle. That's true with any kind of weight loss, including dieting alone.

In one large clinical trial of a GLP-1 medication, about 38% of the weight people lost was lean mass. A joint advisory from four nutrition and obesity medicine groups estimates that without structured strength training, muscle can make up roughly 10–15% of weight lost in women and 20–25% in men.

Why does this matter? Muscle helps you climb stairs, carry groceries and keep your balance. It supports your joints and your blood sugar. It also burns more energy at rest than fat does. Losing too much muscle can leave you weaker, even if the scale looks great.

The good news: there are simple, proven steps that help you hold on to muscle. They're covered in the next section.

PART 04

## Protein and strength: your two muscle protectors

Because these medications turn down hunger, it's easy to eat too little protein without noticing. Protein gives your body the building blocks to keep muscle. Strength training gives your body a reason to keep it.

A 2025 joint advisory from the American College of Lifestyle Medicine, the American Society for Nutrition, the Obesity Medicine Association and The Obesity Society suggests that many people losing weight aim for about 1.2 to 1.6 grams of protein per kilogram of body weight a day, or roughly 80 to 120 grams a day. Your needs may be different, especially if you have kidney disease, so ask your clinician for your number.

The same advisory notes that protein alone is likely not enough. Muscle needs a challenge. U.S. activity guidelines recommend muscle-strengthening work for all major muscle groups at least two days a week.

- Build each meal around protein: eggs, Greek yogurt, cottage cheese, fish, chicken, lean meat, tofu, beans or lentils.
- Eat protein first when your appetite is small, then add vegetables, fruit and whole grains.
- Spread protein across the day instead of saving it for dinner.

- Start strength training with bodyweight moves like sit-to-stands, wall push-ups and step-ups, then add bands or weights.
- Aim for two or three strength sessions a week and add a little challenge over time.
- Keep walking. Daily movement supports heart health, mood and digestion.

> **A simple starting point**
>
> Try a 20-minute routine twice a week: squats to a chair, wall or counter push-ups, rows with a resistance band, glute bridges and a short plank. Two sets of 8 to 12 reps each is plenty to begin. Check with your clinician before starting a new exercise plan.

PART 05

## The free InBody scan: see what the scale can't

A bathroom scale tells you how much you weigh. It can't tell you whether you lost fat, muscle or water. That's why both Serene offices offer a free InBody 580 body-composition scan, starting October 21, 2026.

The scan takes about a minute. You stand on the device barefoot and hold the hand grips. It sends a tiny, painless electrical signal through the body's water to estimate what you're made of. You leave with a printout.

The InBody scan estimates your skeletal muscle mass, body fat mass and percentage, total body water, and visceral fat (the fat around your organs). It also shows muscle and fat in each arm, each leg and your trunk, plus an estimate of the calories you burn at rest. These are estimates to track trends, not a diagnosis.

The scan is always free, and you don't need to buy anything to get one. People with a pacemaker, defibrillator or other implanted electronic device should not be scanned. If you're pregnant, text the office before booking.

- Get a baseline scan before you start any weight-loss plan.
- Repeat every few weeks, at the same time of day, to compare trends.
- Come 2–3 hours after eating and before any workout.
- Skip caffeine, alcohol and exercise beforehand, and use the restroom first.
- Don't put lotion on your hands or feet.
- Watch the trend over several scans rather than any single result. Hydration, your menstrual cycle and swelling can shift a reading.

**What a good trend can look like**

Over time, many people hope to see body fat go down while skeletal muscle holds fairly steady. If your scans show muscle dropping faster than you'd like, that's a signal to talk with your clinician about protein, strength training or your pace of loss.

PART 06

## Side effects to discuss with your clinician

Most side effects of GLP-1 medications involve the stomach and gut. They are often mild and tend to ease as your body adjusts, especially with slow dose increases. Still, you should never push through symptoms without talking to your care team.

Small, regular meals, plenty of fluids and limiting fatty or greasy foods can help. Go easy on alcohol. Stopping eating when you feel comfortably full, not stuffed, helps too.

- Common: nausea, fullness, burping, heartburn, constipation or diarrhea, and lower appetite
- Dehydration from vomiting or diarrhea, which can strain the kidneys
- Low blood sugar, mainly if you also take insulin or certain diabetes pills
- Less common but serious: severe belly pain that won't go away (possible pancreatitis) or pain in the upper right belly (possible gallbladder problems)
- Mood changes or thoughts of self-harm, which should be reported right away
- Upcoming surgery, sedation or procedures: tell your surgeon and anesthesia team you take a GLP-1 medication well ahead of time

**When to get help fast**

Severe or ongoing belly pain, vomiting you can't keep fluids down through, signs of an allergic reaction, or thoughts of harming yourself need urgent care. Call 911 in an emergency. Telehealth is not for emergencies.

PART 07

## Telehealth or in-office: which fits you?

Serene offers medical weight management two ways. You can visit our offices in Hudson, Ohio, or Barboursville, West Virginia. Or you can use Serene Telehealth, with live video visits for people located in Ohio, West Virginia, Kentucky or Florida.

For telehealth, you complete a consent form and upload a photo ID. Visits happen by video in a secure app, where the physician confirms your identity and reviews your history, goals and labs. You must be physically in one of those four states during each visit.

A prescription is only considered after a live video evaluation, and booking a visit doesn't guarantee one. Refills require follow-up visits. Prescriptions are sent electronically to a pharmacy. Serene does not sell or ship medication.

Many people mix the two: telehealth for convenience, plus stops at the office for a free InBody scan to check their body composition.

PART 08

## What happens after you stop

This is one of the most important questions to ask before you start. Obesity is a long-term condition, and these medications work while you take them.

Research shows that weight regain is common after stopping. In one study, people regained up to about two-thirds of the weight they had lost within a year of stopping the medication. Regain happened even with standard nutrition counseling. Appetite usually returns as the medication leaves your system.

That doesn't mean your effort is wasted. Some people stay on medication long term. Others step down slowly with their clinician's guidance. Either way, the habits you build during treatment matter: enough protein, regular strength training, daily movement, good sleep and steady meals.

Muscle you protect during weight loss is an asset afterward. Keeping up repeat InBody scans can help you and your clinician spot changes early, before they become big setbacks.

> **Plan your exit before your start**
> Ask your clinician at the first visit: How long do you expect me to stay on this? How would we taper? What will we watch for after I stop? Having a plan lowers stress later.

# Telehealth vs. in-office care at Serene

| | Serene Telehealth | In-office (Hudson or Barboursville) |
|---|---|---|
| Where | Live video from home; you must be located in OH, WV, KY or FL during the visit | 50 W Streetsboro St, Suite 2, Hudson, OH, or 1 Chateau Grove Ln, Barboursville, WV |
| Program fee | $149/month | $149/month |
| What the fee covers | Video visits, follow-ups and secure messaging | Your medical weight-loss visit and consultation |
| Medication | Billed separately; sent to a pharmacy | Billed separately; prescribed to your pharmacy when appropriate |
| Labs | Paid separately, directly to the lab | See current pricing |
| Free InBody scan | Available if you visit either office | Available at both offices from October 21, 2026 |
| Good fit if | You value convenience or live far from an office | You like face-to-face visits and regular body-composition checks |

# What it costs at Serene

| Treatment | Hudson, OH | Barboursville, WV |
|---|---|---|
| **Medical weight-loss program (in-office)**<br>Covers your medical consultation and visit. Medication is billed separately. | $149/month | $149/month |
| **Serene Telehealth weight management**<br>Covers video visits, follow-ups and secure messaging. Medication and labs are extra. Insurance is not billed for telehealth. | $149/month | $149/month |
| **GLP-1 medication**<br>Prescribed to your pharmacy when appropriate. Cost depends on the medication, your pharmacy and your insurance; many plans require prior authorization. | Billed separately | Billed separately |
| **Lab work**<br>Bring recent labs if you have them. Telehealth labs are paid directly to the lab. | See current pricing | See current pricing |
| **InBody 580 body-composition scan**<br>Starts October 21, 2026. Always free, as often as you like, no purchase required. | Free | Free |
| **New-client offer**<br>20% off your first visit — applies to any product or service; can't be combined with another discount | 20% off first visit | 20% off first visit |

Prices as of October 2026; see serenemedspas.com for current pricing.

## Your consultation checklist

- [ ] Bring a list of every medicine, vitamin and supplement you take, with doses.
- [ ] Bring recent lab results if you have them, and ask which labs you may need.
- [ ] Know your health history and family history, including any thyroid cancer, pancreatitis or gallbladder problems.
- [ ] Tell us if you are pregnant, planning a pregnancy or breastfeeding.
- [ ] Get a free InBody scan first so you have a baseline for muscle and body fat.
- [ ] Ask: Am I a candidate for a GLP-1 medication, and why or why not?
- [ ] Ask: How will we raise my dose, and what side effects should I report right away?
- [ ] Ask: What is my daily protein target, and how much strength training should I do?
- [ ] Ask: What will medication cost me with my insurance or pharmacy?
- [ ] Ask: How long might I stay on treatment, and what's the plan if I stop?

## Frequently asked questions

**How much weight will I lose?**
Results vary. Your starting point, health conditions, medication response, eating habits and activity all play a role. Your clinician can talk with you about realistic goals and how progress will be measured.

**Do I have to give myself shots?**
Most GLP-1 medications are once-weekly injections using a small pen. Our team will show you how to use it. If you have concerns about injections, bring them up during your visit.

**Will I lose muscle?**
Some lean mass loss is normal with any weight loss. Eating enough protein, strength training at least twice a week and tracking body composition with repeat InBody scans can help you protect muscle.

**Is the InBody scan really free?**
Yes. The InBody 580 scan is free at both Serene offices starting October 21, 2026, as often as you like, with no purchase required. It takes about a minute and you get a printout.

**Does the $149 monthly fee include medication?**
No. The $149/month program fee covers your physician visits. Medication is billed separately through your pharmacy, and labs are separate too.

**Does Serene bill insurance?**
Insurance is not billed for telehealth visits. Your pharmacy benefit may or may not cover the medication itself; many plans require prior authorization. Check with your insurer and ask our team for details.

**Can I do this entirely by telehealth?**
Yes, if you are located in Ohio, West Virginia, Kentucky or Florida during your visits and the physician finds treatment appropriate after a live video evaluation. A prescription is never guaranteed.

**What if I stop the medication?**
Many people regain some or much of the lost weight after stopping. Talk with your clinician about a long-term plan, and keep up protein, strength training and repeat scans to protect your progress.

YOUR NEXT STEP

# Ready when you are

- Book a free InBody scan at either office (starting October 21, 2026) to get your baseline muscle and body fat numbers.
- Book your medical weight-loss consultation online: Hudson at serenemedspas.com/hudson/ or Barboursville at serenemedspas.com/barboursville/.
- Prefer to text? Hudson: (330) 303-2031. Barboursville: (304) 396-0295.
- Live in Ohio, West Virginia, Kentucky or Florida and want care from home? Ask about Serene Telehealth video visits.
- New clients: 20% off your first visit — applies to any product or service; can't be combined with another discount.

### Hudson, Ohio

50 W Streetsboro St, Suite 2
Text (330) 303-2031 · Call (330) 460-5915
serenemedspas.com/hudson

### Barboursville, West Virginia

1 Chateau Grove Ln
Text (304) 396-0295 · Call (304) 520-0461
serenemedspas.com/barboursville

Scan a code to see pricing and book online.

## Important

This guide is for general education only and is not medical advice. It does not replace an evaluation by a licensed clinician. Prescription medications are considered only after a medical evaluation and are not right for everyone. Results vary, and no specific outcome is guaranteed. InBody results are estimates to track trends and are not a diagnosis. If you have a medical emergency, call 911. Prices are as of October 2026 and may change; see serenemedspas.com for current pricing.

## Sources


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